

Executive Summary

The Erasmus+ funded project “A Micro-Survey Framework for Inclusion and Diversity in Vocational Education (ID-VET)” aims to uncover barriers to diversity and inclusion (DI) across five European vocational schools. Through collaboration with StudentPulse, over **72,000 student responses** were collected and analyzed, forming the basis for a data-driven framework to improve student well-being, equity, and engagement.

This report synthesizes findings from three institutions: **Mercantec (Denmark)**, **Rakvere Ametikool (Estonia)**, and **Centro de Formación Somorrostro (Spain)**. Each school provided unique insights into student experiences, highlighting both strengths and areas for improvement in mental health, learning environments, social inclusion, and economic support.

Key Statistics Highlights

- **Total student responses across all schools:** 72,908
 - **Rakvere:**
 - Responses: 7,745
 - Happiness at school: 7.1/10
 - Economic support: 8.5/10
 - Family support: 8.3/10
 - Awareness of bullying support: 8.2/10
 - Concentration in class: 6.8/10
 - Morning motivation: 5.5/10
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Core Themes and Insights

1. Mental Health and Well-being – the schools noticed that:

- Students often rely on peers rather than formal support systems. Many are unaware of who to talk to when feeling down, indicating a gap in mental health infrastructure.
- While most students report feeling supported, some express anxiety and pressure due to long school days and early start times.
- Strategic investment in neurodivergent support and mental health initiatives is underway, aiming to address specific student needs.

Recommendation: Schools should increase visibility of mental health resources, train staff in mental health literacy, and foster a culture of openness and trust.

2. Learning Environment and Concentration – the schools noticed that:

- Students struggle with concentration due to classroom disruptions and early fatigue. Teaching quality and lesson engagement are key factors.
- Noise and lack of respect in classrooms hinder effective learning. Students report difficulty focusing due to peer behavior.
- Continued use of micro-surveys helps monitor and improve learning conditions.

Recommendation: Improve classroom management, adjust schedules to reduce fatigue, and enhance teacher training in engagement strategies.

3. Social Inclusion and Peer Relationships – the schools noticed that:

- While many students feel respected, others report bullying and exclusion. Some feel the school does not effectively address these issues.
- Strong peer relationships contribute positively to the learning environment, though some students feel uncertain or unmotivated.
- Focus on knowing each student individually and investing in social activities to strengthen inclusion.

Recommendation: Promote empathy and respect through peer programs, establish clear anti-bullying protocols, and ensure all students feel seen and valued.

4. Economic Awareness and Support – the schools noticed that:

- Students generally feel financially secure and supported by their families, though a minority report economic pressure.
- Economic concerns are less prominent but still present.
- Data-driven understanding of students' economic situations informs targeted support.

Recommendation: Provide clear guidance on financial aid, ensure students know where to seek help, and monitor economic stress indicators.

5. Diversity and Inclusion – the schools noticed that:

- Reports of discrimination and xenophobia highlight the need for proactive DEI initiatives. Some students feel excluded due to cultural or personal identity.
- Mixed sentiments about belonging and motivation suggest room for improvement in inclusive practices.
- Strategic focus on inclusion through personalized student engagement.

Recommendation: Implement DEI training for staff and students, create safe spaces for dialogue, and establish transparent reporting systems for discrimination.

Conclusion

The ID-VET project has provided valuable insights into the lived experiences of vocational students across Europe. While many strengths were identified—such as peer support and economic stability—critical areas like mental health, classroom engagement, and inclusivity require focused attention.

The micro-survey framework developed through this project offers a scalable and data-driven tool for continuous improvement, ensuring that VET institutions can better support all students in their educational journey.